

OCCASIONEM COGNOSCE

A POEM BY

MARIANNE MOORE



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*For Richard Thomas —
hoping it is not a thing that
you could not under any circumstances
have wanted, Mr. Thomas*

*Marianne Moore
May 6. 1963*

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I've been thinking—
I mean cogitating

Make a fuss
and be tedious.

I'm annoyed?
yes; am— avoid

"adore"
and "bore";

am, I
say, by

the word
bore, bored;

refuse
to use

"divine"
to mean

something
pleasing:

'terrific color'
for some horror.

Though flat,
myself, I'd say that

"Atlas"
(pressed glass)

looks best
embossed.

I refuse
to use

"enchant",
"dement";

even 'fright-
ful plight'
(however justified)

or 'frivol-
ous fool'
(however suitable).

I've escaped?
am still trapped

by these
word diseases.

No pauses—
the phrases

lack lyric
force; sound capric—

like Attic
capric-Alcaic,

or freak
calico-Greek.

(Not verse
of course)
I'm sure of this:

Nothing mundane is divine;
Nothing divine is mundane.